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SHIV SHANKAR MENON

60, National Security Adviser



The Protector

Because despite the embarrassment of the Sharm el-Sheikh joint statement, he is back with a promotion as the National Security Adviser.

Because he influences key foreign policy decisions and is driving diplomatic initiatives with Pakistan and China.

Because he has a rapport not only with Manmohan Singh, but also Rahul Gandhi.

Becausehe shares Manmohan's vision of repairing ties in the neighbourhood.

Because despite speculation that internal security may go to the Home Ministry, as NSA, he wields full power.

Did you know He played for a rock band at his alma mater, the Scindia School in Gwalior.



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G.K. PILLAI

61, Home Secretary

Home Management

Because he was handpicked to team up with P. Chidambaram, known for his exacting standards, in reviving and reforming the somnolent Home Ministry.

Becauseseasoned intelligence and security experts look up to him for advice.

Becausehis knowledge of the North-east is legendary and if anyone can resolve the long-standing Naga problem, or tame the ULFA, it is him.

Did you know In his youth, Pillai, the film buff, used to sell old newspapers to finance his movie-going habit.

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V.K. DUGGAL

65, Former Home Secretary

Trouble Tamer

Becausehe is the man the Government reaches out to in a domestic crisis, whether it is as member secretary of the Srikrishna Committee on Telangana or as member of the committee on Centre-state relations.

Becausehis influence in the government, irrespective of the party in power, is a tribute to his networking skills.

Becausehe is equally at ease charming guests with his flamboyance at swish society soirees.

Did you know he was in the army from 1966 to 1972, and served in Bangladesh with the present army chief General Deepak Kapoor.



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GOPAL SUBRAMANIAM

51, Solicitor General

Laws and Effect

Becausehe is the man the Government always turns to for legal aid in high-profile cases.

Becausehe came up with a unique way of fast forwarding many social objectives through the judicial process, ensuring the rights of children, drawing up a code to end muscle power in college elections and initiating strong measures against students found guilty of ragging.

Did you know he can't do without communicating with his 10 dogs as "they bring out the best in men".

